MAKANZA PEATLAND CONSERVATION PROJECT, DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC OF CONGO

Project title	Makanza Peatland Conservation Project, Democratic Republic of Congo
Project ID	6008
Crediting period	01-January-2027 to 31-December-2066
Original date of issue	27-January-2026
Most recent date of issue	27-January-2026
Version	Version 1.0
***VCS Standard* Version**	Version 5.0
Prepared by	FRM Ingénierie (FRMi)

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1 PROJECT DETAILS

1.1 Summary Description of the Project

Located in the north-western part of the of the Democratic Republic of Congo, in the heart of the "Cuvette Centrale" peatland complex, the Makanza Peatland Conservation Project is designed to protect 188,677 ha of intact peatland and swamp forest ecosystems. The Project is situated within the Forest Concession n°006/25 du 31 juillet 2025 – Makanza, hereinafter referred to as the Makanza Concession. This concession, unassigned until July 2025, is now assigned and managed by *Congo Nature Tourbières* to promote sustainable land use and protect the unique ecological and climatic functions of Congo Basin peatlands.

The concession is currently being developed into a long-term REDD+ conservation project under the Verified Carbon Standard (VCS) framework. The Makanza project aims to protect and sustainably manage peatland and forest ecosystems that remain largely undisturbed but are increasingly threatened by agricultural expansion, population growth, and unsustainable resource extraction. By doing so, the project will prevent the release of massive quantities of carbon stored in peat soils and forest biomass accumulated over thousands of years.

In the baseline scenario, the area would progressively face unplanned deforestation and degradation driven by subsistence agriculture, fuelwood collection, and population growth along river axes. This process would lead to the oxidation of peat deposits and substantial greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions.

The main activity of the Makanza Peatland Conservation Project is to avoid these unplanned emissions by establishing a protected peatland management system, including conservation and surveillance of intact peatland and forest zones, participatory zoning defining development and conservation areas, promotion of alternative livelihoods and sustainable resource management, environmental awareness campaigns for local communities, monitoring and research on peatland ecological components.

By ceasing and preventing destructive land-use activities observed in the baseline, the project aims to avoid emissions from forest clearance, drainage, burning, and soil decomposition.

By avoiding unplanned deforestation and peat degradation and by maintaining the ecological integrity of these carbon-dense landscapes, the project will prevent substantial GHG emissions and contribute to long-term carbon sequestration through natural peat accumulation and forest growth.

A further advantage of the project area is the proximity of the Triangle de la Ngiri Reserve, which includes, among other species, bonobo, forest elephant, Congolese peacock or Bongo antelope, and the Ngiri-Tumba - Maï Ndombe cross-border Ramsar Site, the world's largest Ramsar Site[1].

The project applies the VCS VM0007 methodology, using VMD0042 (BL-PEAT) for the peatland component and VMD007 for aboveground biomass, to quantify the emission reductions resulting from conservation activities. It will generate carbon credits for the voluntary market under the VCS Standard.

The first crediting period is 40 years. Gross avoided GHG emissions (prior to leakage deductions) are estimated at 23,813,975 tCO_2e (i.e., 595,349 tCO_2e/year). Leakage will be assessed and deducted in accordance with the applied VCS methodology. A portion of the issued VCUs will be allocated to the AFOLU VCS buffer account.

[1] https://rsis.ramsar.org/ris/1784

1.2 Audit History

This section is not applicable because the project is not in the process of being renewed or validated: the project is under development.

1.3 Sectoral Scope and Project Type

Sectoral scope	Sectoral scope 14 (Agriculture, Forestry and Other Land Use)
AFOLU project category[2]	Reduced Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD)
Project activity type	Avoiding Unplanned Deforestation and/or Degradation (AUDD) Conservation of intact wetlands (CIW), which includes avoiding unplanned wetland degradation (AUWD)

1.4 Project Eligibility

1.4.1 General eligibility

The project is eligible under the scope of the VCS Program (see details in Table 1 below).

Table 1: Reason for the Project's eligibility for the VCS program – General eligibility

Criterion	Fulfilled? (Yes/No)	Justification / Explanation
The project should not be part of the ineligible project activities (see Table 1 in VCS Standard v5)	Yes	No, REDD projects are included in this list of ineligible project activities.
The project meets requirements related to the pipeline listing deadline, the opening meeting with the validation/verification body, and the validation deadline.	Yes	Project proponents shall submit a pipeline listing request within one year of the start date of the initial crediting period. As the initial crediting period starts on 01 January 2027, the pipeline listing request must be submitted no later than 01 January 2028. Regarding the opening meeting with the validation/verification body: the project is under development and the validation process has not yet begun, so no opening meeting was held with the VVB. Regarding the registration deadline, AFOLU projects shall submit an initial registration request within five years of the start date of the initial crediting period. As the initial crediting period starts on 01 January 2027, the initial registration request must be submitted no later than 01 January 2032.

[2] See Appendix 1 of the VCS Standard v5

Criterion	Fulfilled? (Yes/No)	Justification / Explanation
The applied methodology is eligible under the VCS Program.	Yes	The methodology applied as part of this project is the VM0007 methodology, version 1.8 approved on June 04, 2024 by the VCS Program[3]. According to VCS Methodology Requirements v5 (section 3.2) there are currently seven AFOLU project categories under the VCS Program, as further described in Appendix 1 Eligible AFOLU Project Categories. Proposed AFOLU methodologies shall fall within one or more of these AFOLU project categories: the VM0007 methodology falls into the REDD category.

1.4.2 AFOLU project eligibility

The project is eligible under the scope of the VCS Program (see details in Table 2 below).

Table 2: Reason for the Project's eligibility for the VCS program – AFOLU project eligibility

Criterion	Fulfilled? (Yes/No)	Justification / Explanation
According to the VCS Standard v5 and the VCS Methodology Requirements (Appendix 1: Eligible AFOLU Project Categories), eligible REDD activities reduce net GHG emissions by reducing deforestation and/or degradation of forests. Deforestation is the direct, human-induced conversion of forest land to non-forest land. Degradation is the persistent reduction in canopy cover and/or carbon stocks in a forest due to human activities such as animal grazing, fuelwood extraction, timber removal, or other such activities, but which does not result in the conversion of forest to non-forest land (which would be classified as deforestation) and qualifies as forests remaining as forests, such as set out in the IPCC 2003 Good Practice Guidance for Land Use, Land-Use Change and Forestry.	Yes	The project is eligible under the REDD category by virtue of the fact that it prevents emissions by reducing deforestation and degradation of forests in the Makanza Conservation Concession (Forest Concession n°006/25) which is an area that could be affected by deforestation or degradation due to the absence of effective prior protection measures.

[3] https://verra.org/methodologies/vm0007-redd-methodology-framework-redd-mf-v1-8/

Criterion	Fulfilled? (Yes/No)	Justification / Explanation
As set out in REDD methodologies, the project area must qualify as forest for a minimum of 10 years before the project start date. In the VCS Program, secondary forests are considered to be forests that have been cleared and have recovered naturally and that are at least 10 years old and meet the lower bound of forest threshold parameters at the start of the project. Forested wetlands, such as floodplain forests, peatland forests, and mangrove forests, are also eligible provided they meet forest definition requirements.	Yes	The project comprises tropical primary forest over peat soils. Such forests are eligible provided they meet the applicable forest definition requirements. To demonstrate eligibility, a GIS-based cartographic assessment was conducted using multi-temporal remote sensing and available reference layers to confirm that the selected areas (i) meet the forest threshold parameters at the project start date and (ii) remained forested throughout the 10-year pre-project period. Areas showing evidence of clearing/conversion, non-forest cover, or not meeting the forest definition were excluded from the final project boundary. The final delineated project area therefore includes only forested land that satisfies the VCS REDD eligibility criterion and the forest definition requirements.
REDD activities are designed to stop planned (designated and sanctioned) deforestation or unplanned (unsanctioned) deforestation and/or degradation. Avoided planned degradation is classified as IFM.	Yes	The project targets unplanned (unsanctioned) deforestation and/or degradation within the project area. The main drivers are small-scale agricultural encroachment and small-scale resource extraction, which lead to forest clearance and/or persistent reductions in canopy and carbon stocks. Therefore, the project activities are consistent with the REDD category under the VCS Program.
Activities that stop unsanctioned deforestation and/or illegal degradation (e.g., removal of fuelwood or timber extracted by non-concessionaires) on lands that are legally sanctioned for timber production are eligible as REDD activities.	No	Not applicable. The project area is not located on lands legally sanctioned for timber production (i.e., it does not overlap with timber concessions or other areas designated for legal timber harvesting). Consequently, the eligibility provision related to stopping unsanctioned deforestation and/or illegal degradation by non-concessionaires on timber-production lands does not apply to this project.

1.4.3 Transfer project eligibility

This section does not apply since the proposed project isn't a transfer project or a Component Project Activity (CPA).

1.5 Project Design

☒ Single location or installation

☐ Multiple locations or project activity instances (but not a grouped project)

☐ Grouped project

1.5.1 Grouped project design

This section does not apply since the proposed project isn't a grouped project.

1.6 Project Proponent

Organization name	Congo Nature Tourbières (CNT)
Contact person	Morgan CASSAGNE
Title	Project Manager
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1.7 Other Entities Involved in the Project

Organization name	FRM Ingénierie (FRMi)
Role in the project	Consultant Technical Lead in Project Development Technical support for calculation of emission reductions Redaction of the PDD Subsidiary of the FRM Group
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Organization name	FRM RDC
Role in the project	Consultant Technical Lead in Project Development
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Organization name	NGO, to be selected
Role in the project	Technical Operator for community development
Contact person	
Title	Coordinator
Address	
Telephone	
Email	

1.8 Ownership

Land ownership

According to the "Contrat de Concession Forestière de Conservation n°006/25 du 31 juillet 2025" between the Congolese Government and CNT (available upon request) the Makanza forest concession, of 231,090 ha, became a conservation forest concession in favor of the CNT company.

Conservation forest concessions are, as much as timber exploitation concessions, regulated by Law No. 011/2002 of August 29, 2002 on the Forest Code[4] (art. 82 to 95 and art. 119) and its application

[4] http://www.droit-afrique.com/upload/doc/rdc/RDC-Code-2002-forestier.pdf

measures (Decree No. 011/27 of May 20, 2011 setting the specific rules for the allocation of conservation forest concessions[5]). Based on these texts, the regulations in force have clearly provided for specific conditions to be met by any individual or legal entity wishing to enter into a forestry concession contract for timber exploitation or conservation as well as the procedure to be followed by the public administration for this purpose.

In addition, the Democratic Republic of Congo wishes to ensure that the activities implemented within the framework of the REDD+ mechanism develop in coherence with the international agreements and treaties ratified by the State and with the policies and measures in force, in accordance with the decisions of the XVI Conference of the Parties to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change. In this perspective, any project intended to promote its reductions in greenhouse gas emissions linked to REDD+ on the carbon markets or with international institutional buyers, as the Makanza Project, must be subject to prior approval by the Democratic Republic of Congo[6].

The national approval procedure contributes, on the one hand, to the concretization of the commitments made by the DRC within the framework of international agreements and conventions and, on the other hand, to the consistency of REDD+ projects with the existing national framework, in particular the policies and measures, law, eligibility criteria and social and environmental safeguards. The approval of a REDD+ project attests to the legitimacy of the promoter of this REDD+ project with regard to the Congolese State and constitutes a right to promote REDD+ performance on the carbon markets or with any buyer of REDD+ performance from a project located within the borders of the DRC.

As part of the approval, the land rights of CNT in the project area, and the means of obtaining these rights, are verified. In fact, according to the article 10 of the « Arrêté Ministériel n°47/CAB/MIN/EDD/AAN/MML/05/2018 fixant la procédure d'homologation des investissements REDD+ en République Démocratique du Congo (J.O.RDC., 1er juillet 2018, n°13, col. 58)[7] » : in the event that the implementation of the REDD+ investment requires the occupation of any land whatsoever, whether forest land or not, the existence in the file of a deed of commitment by the bearer of the investment to obtain the prior agreement of the holder(s) of the pre-existing land rights, individual or collective, given in full knowledge of the facts and without moral or physical constraint; in this case, the deed of engagement conforms to the model set out in the manual.

Project ownership

Carbon credits generated by the project will be shared among the State, local communities, and the project proponent (i.e., FRM Commitment), in accordance with the sharing clause in the conservation concession contract.

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[5] https://faolex.fao.org/docs/pdf/cng111044.pdf

[6] https://www.forestcarbonpartnership.org/sites/fcp/files/2015/March/Annexe%20I%20Manuel_Proc%C3%A9dure_Homologation_r%C3%A9vision_version_finale_24f%C3%A9vrier.pdf

[7] https://faolex.fao.org/docs/pdf/Cng189387.pdf

1.9 Project Start Date

Project start date	01-January-2027
Requirements	3.7.1 The project start date shall: 1) be consistent with the definition of project start date in the VCS Program Definitions. 2) conform to any criteria set out in the applied methodology. 3) be established based on implementation of the earliest of the first significant actions, where the project includes multiple project activities. 4) be no later than the initial crediting period start date. 3.7.2 The project start date shall not be determined based on either of the following: 1) Pilot testing in the project area that: a) is limited to research (e.g., feasibility studies or trials), b) comprises activities that are not monitored as part of the project, or c) does not introduce permanent changes in land use 2) Stakeholder engagement activities that are required to occur prior to the project start date.
Justification	Activities leading to the generation of GHG emission reductions or removals have not yet started.

1.10 Project Crediting Period

Crediting period	☐ Seven years, twice renewable ☐ Ten years, fixed ☒ Other: 40 years
Start and end date of first or fixed crediting period	01-January-2027 to 31-Decembre-2066, *i.e.* 40 years. This crediting period conforms with the VCS Program requirements as the initial project crediting period for an AFOLU project shall be a minimum of 20 years up to a maximum of 100 years.

1.11 Project Scale and Estimated GHG Emission Reductions or Removals

The estimated annual GHG emission reductions/removals (ERRs) of the project are:

☐ < 300,000 tCO_2e/year (project)

☒ ≥ 300,000 tCO_2e/year (large project)

The calculation of emission reductions for Reduced Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation follows the VCS Standard v5 and the VM0007 Methodology, with additional modules such as VMD0007. The estimated GHG emission reductions and removals for the entire project crediting period are outlined in the table below. These estimates do not account for the buffer.

Table 3: Estimated reductions or removals

Calendar year of crediting period	Estimated GHG emission reductions or removals (tCO_2e)
1 January 2027 to 31 December 2027	266,077
1 January 2028 to 31 December 2028	283,606
1 January 2029 to 31 December 2029	301,085
1 January 2030 to 31 December 2030	318,514
1 January 2031 to 31 December 2031	335,894
1 January 2032 to 31 December 2032	353,224
1 January 2030 to 33 December 2033	370,504
1 January 2034 to 31 December 2034	387,736
1 January 2035 to 31 December 2035	404,918
1 January 2036 to 31 December 2036	422,050
1 January 2037 to 31 December 2037	439,134
1 January 2038 to 31 December 2038	456,170
1 January 2039 to 31 December 2039	473,156
1 January 2040 to 31 December 2040	490,094
1 January 2041 to 31 December 2041	506,983

Calendar year of crediting period	Estimated GHG emission reductions or removals (tCO_2e)
1 January 2042 to 31 December 2042	523,824
1 January 2043 to 31 December 2043	540,617
1 January 2044 to 31 December 2044	557,361
1 January 2045 to 31 December 2045	574,058
1 January 2046 to 31 December 2046	590,707
1 January 2047 to 31 December 2047	607,307
1 January 2048 to 31 December 2048	623,861
1 January 2049 to 31 December 2049	640,366
1 January 2050 to 31 December 2050	656,825
1 January 2051 to 31 December 2051	673,236
1 January 2052 to 31 December 2052	689,599
1 January 2053 to 31 December 2053	705,916
1 January 2054 to 31 December 2054	722,186
1 January 2055 to 31 December 2055	738,408
1 January 2056 to 31 December 2056	754,585
1 January 2057 to 31 December 2057	770,714
1 January 2058 to 31 December 2058	786,797
1 January 2059 to 31 December 2059	802,834
1 January 2060 to 31 December 2060	818,824
1 January 2061 to 31 December 2061	834,768
1 January 2062 to 31 December 2062	850,666
1 January 2063 to 31 December 2063	866,518
1 January 2064 to 31 December 2064	882,324

Calendar year of crediting period	Estimated GHG emission reductions or removals (tCO_2e)
1 January 2065 to 31 December 2065	891,627
1 January 2066 to 31 December 2066	900,903
Total estimated ERRs during the first or fixed crediting period	23,813,975
Total number of years	40
Average annual ERRs	595,349

1.12 Description of the Project Activity

The project area is entirely within the Makanza Concession (231,090 ha) in the north-west of the Democratic Republic of Congo. To successfully protect a significant portion of the swamp forests within the concession, the concession must be divided into two areas: a rural development area (see § 1.13 for more details) not included in the project, and a project area where ecosystem protection will be implemented.

The main objective of the Project is to protect peatland and swamp forest ecosystems by stopping deforestation and/or forest degradation (i.e., AUDD). AUDD activities will maintain and protect ecosystems inside the project area (188,677 ha).

Community activities will also be developed in the rural development area, but their impacts will not be accounted for in emission reductions, as they occur outside the project area.

This project is not located within a REDD+ jurisdictional program.

Project development and beginning

2025 and the beginning of 2026 were, and will be, devoted to the technical and socio-environmental feasibility studies of the Project, as well as studies of opportunity and economic feasibility.

It was at the end of 2025 that the project took its first steps with:

- According to the "Contrat de Concession Forestière de Conservation n°006/25 du 31 juillet 2025" between the Congolese Government and CNT (available upon request) the Makanza forest concession, of 231,090 ha, became at this date a conservation forest concession in favor of the CNT company (see § 1.8 for more details on the procedure).
- A first exploratory mission with the aim of apprehending the ecosystems and approaching and gathering support for the project from local communities

Exploration of ecosystems

Meeting with local communities and authorities

Other missions will follow in order to obtain Free, Prior, and Informed Consent (FPIC) and define the zoning of the concessions, in particular to delimit and distinguish between the rural development area and the project area.

AUDD activities

This project aims to prevent the GHG emission by stopping deforestation and/or degradation of the forests that would have occurred in any forest configuration.

Forest degradatrion

By stopping these destructive activities, the project will also reduce disturbance to the fauna in this area, which is very rich and varied, thanks to its proximity to the Triangle de la Ngiri Reserve, which includes, among other species, bonobos (*Pan paniscus*), forest elephants (*Loxodonta cyclotis*), Congolese peacocks (*Afropavo congensis*), and bongo antelope, (*Tragelaphus eurycerus*)[8]. The lack of infrastructure development will also deter illegal activities, making them more difficult to carry out.

Because of the intrinsic conservation nature of this REDD project, there are no specific technologies, services or products involved in its implementation. The activities of the AUDD focus on the supervision and monitoring of the concession forests. In order to monitor any disturbances that may affect the whole forest, a permanent control team that monitors the state of the forest with regard to hunting, fires etc. will be installed.

Other activities

To conserve forests, the project will help maintain and improve local development, environmental, and social services for communities and indigenous peoples across the Makanza Concession. In fact, the project area includes High Conservation Value (HCV) areas, including swamp forests associated with some of the largest peatland complexes in the world, the “Cuvette Centrale” and the Congo Basin peatland areas. These peatlands are essential for carbon storage, as peatlands store more carbon than

[8] https://rsis.ramsar.org/es/ris/1784

any other natural terrestrial system: 6,300 tons of CO_2 per hectare in peat soils, compared to 250 tons of CO_2 per hectare in the soils of non-peat tropical forests (Crezee et al, 2022[9]).

The desired outcome is to provide people with income opportunities that are not destructive to the rainforest, as they have traditionally done. To this end, several activities will be developed in close collaboration with local communities (through their Free, Prior and Informed Consent; see § 2.1.3). The implementation of these activities and their impact on emission reductions will not be accounted for in this carbon project. However, a portion of the revenue from the sale of carbon credits generated by the AUDD project will directly support the development and sustainability of these activities.

These activities are, for example:

- Monitoring of illegal activities (logging, poaching) in the whole concession and, in case of flagrante offence, working with the local authorities in order to carry out conciliation missions to deter criminal behavior. The objective is not to repress and punish but to get in touch with people engaged in illegal activities in order to be able to raise their awareness as a priority on the consequences of their actions and to offer them priority alternative income-generating activities and non-destructive of the environment;
- Sensitization of local populations about the impact of deforestation and the importance of preserving forests;
- Sensitization of local populations about the impact of poaching and the importance of preserving animal biodiversity in partnership with the Triangle de la Ngiri Reserve. The region where the rainforest we protect is located is home to wildlife found nowhere else. This is particularly true for endangered species such as the bonobo. We plan to both carefully protect their natural habitats and to work with the local wildlife protection groups;
- Sensitization of local populations to the limits of the rural development zone, the objective being to make them understand that their activities must be confined to this zone, which is dedicated to them and that they must not extend into the conservation zones. This sensitization will be accompanied by a reflection, in consultation with the local populations, on the means to optimize and sustain their food and income-generating activities in this rural development zone (see the activities that will be proposed below);
- Development of sustainable agriculture with three main objectives: food security, local income generation and sedentarisation/stabilization of slash-and-burn agriculture. Several activities will then be possible:
    - Sensitization and training in sustainable agricultural practices with agronomists;
    - Agroforestry: combining the usual food crops of local populations (cassava, peanuts, etc.) with tree plantations, such as Acacia trees, which will fertilize the soil (because they are nitrogen fixers), and thus increase yields, and which can also be used to produce charcoal, as a substitute of the firewood supply in natural forests;

[9] Crezee, B., Dargie, G.C., Ewango, C.E.N. et al. Mapping peat thickness and carbon stocks of the central Congo Basin using field data. Nat. Geosci. 15, 639–644 (2022).

- Planting of oil palms and/or cash crops in order to develop new income-generating sectors. These activities will be accompanied by the installation of processing units (e.g., oil mills), packaging and transport;
- Provision of improved seeds to local populations;
- NTFPs gathering, such as honey (installation of beehives in Acacia agroforestry plantations) or caterpillars;
- Livestock: support for local populations in terms of veterinary services and marketing of animal products to the capital.

For the realization of some of these activities, and to guarantee their success, CNT will request the technical support an environmental civil society organization (to be determined) that supports community development and sustainable management of natural resources. If necessary, other technical partnerships could be set up to oversee and support the planned community activities.

In addition to the specific items mentioned above, we are continuously searching - in close collaboration with local communities - for new, innovative, more efficient, environmentally friendly methods to achieve our goal of maximizing the improvement of living conditions for the population in the DRC while having long lasting positive effects on the economy of the region.

1.13 Project Location

The Makanza Concession is located in the north-west of the Democratic Republic of Congo, in the "Cuvette centrale". It is located between the Ngiri River to the west and the Congo River to the east. This forest massif extends between latitudes 156,000 and 191,000 North and longitudes 210,000 and 261,000 East (see Figure 1).

Administratively, the Makanza Concession is entirely located in:

- The Province: Equateur;
- The Territories: Bomongo and Makanza;
- The Sector: Djamba, Bangala and Ndobo;
- The Makanza, Mabembe, Mbenga, Boboka, Ndobo, Bomana, Bongondo, Bonsenge and Libanda Groups.

Makanza, chief town of the Makanza territory

According to the conservation concession contract, the Makanza Concession covers a total area of 231,090 ha. To provide rural populations with a land reserve of 42,413 ha for future agricultural activities, an area allocated to rural development, including the existing clearings, was identified during Project development. This area is to be excluded from the limits of the Project, and no VCUs will be issued from it.

The project area corresponds to the remainder of the concession and represents 188,677 ha.

The Figure 2 presents the spatial organization of the Makanza Concession. The project area is located within the Makanza Concession (Figure 2).

Figure 1: Location of the Makanza Concession

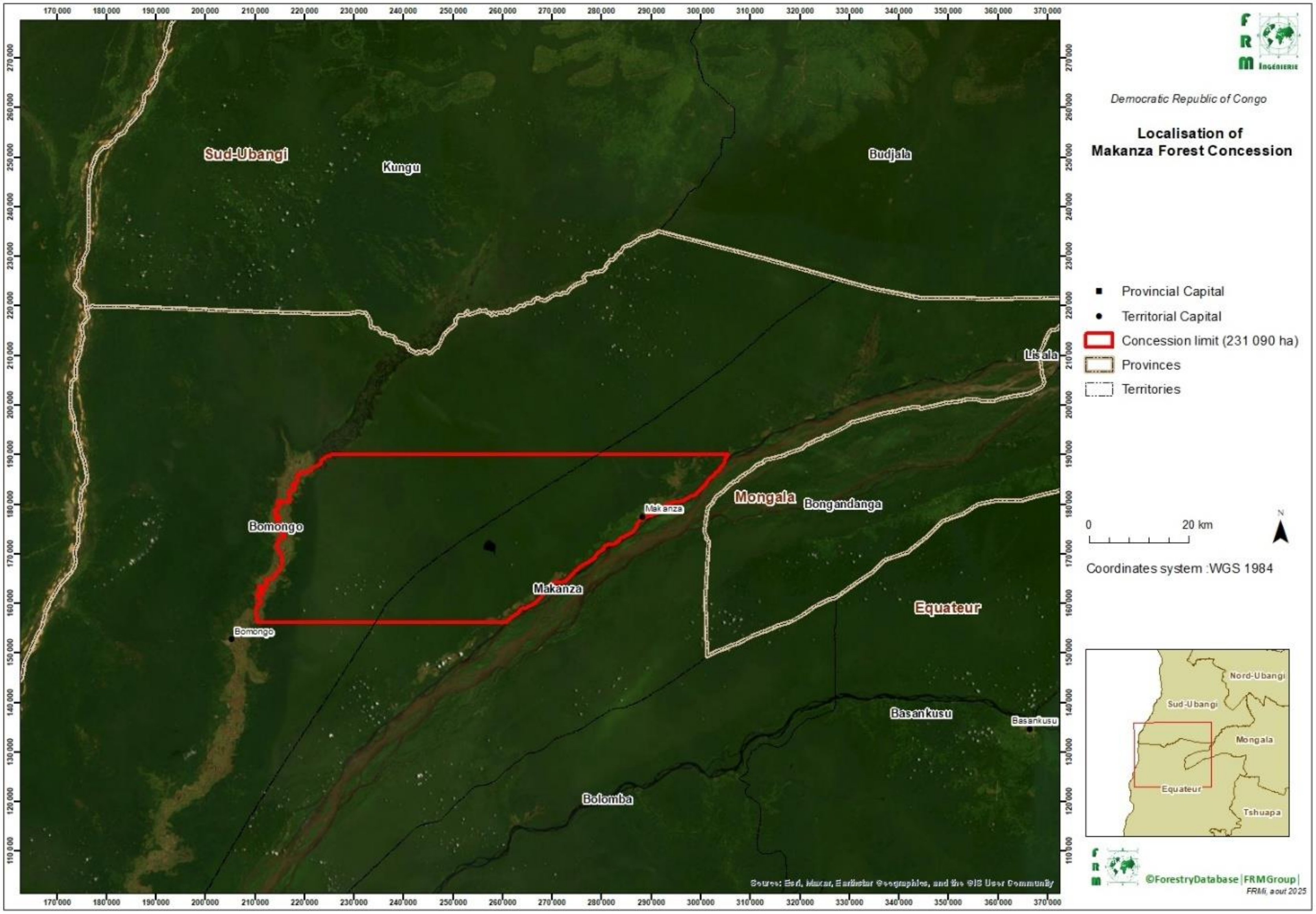
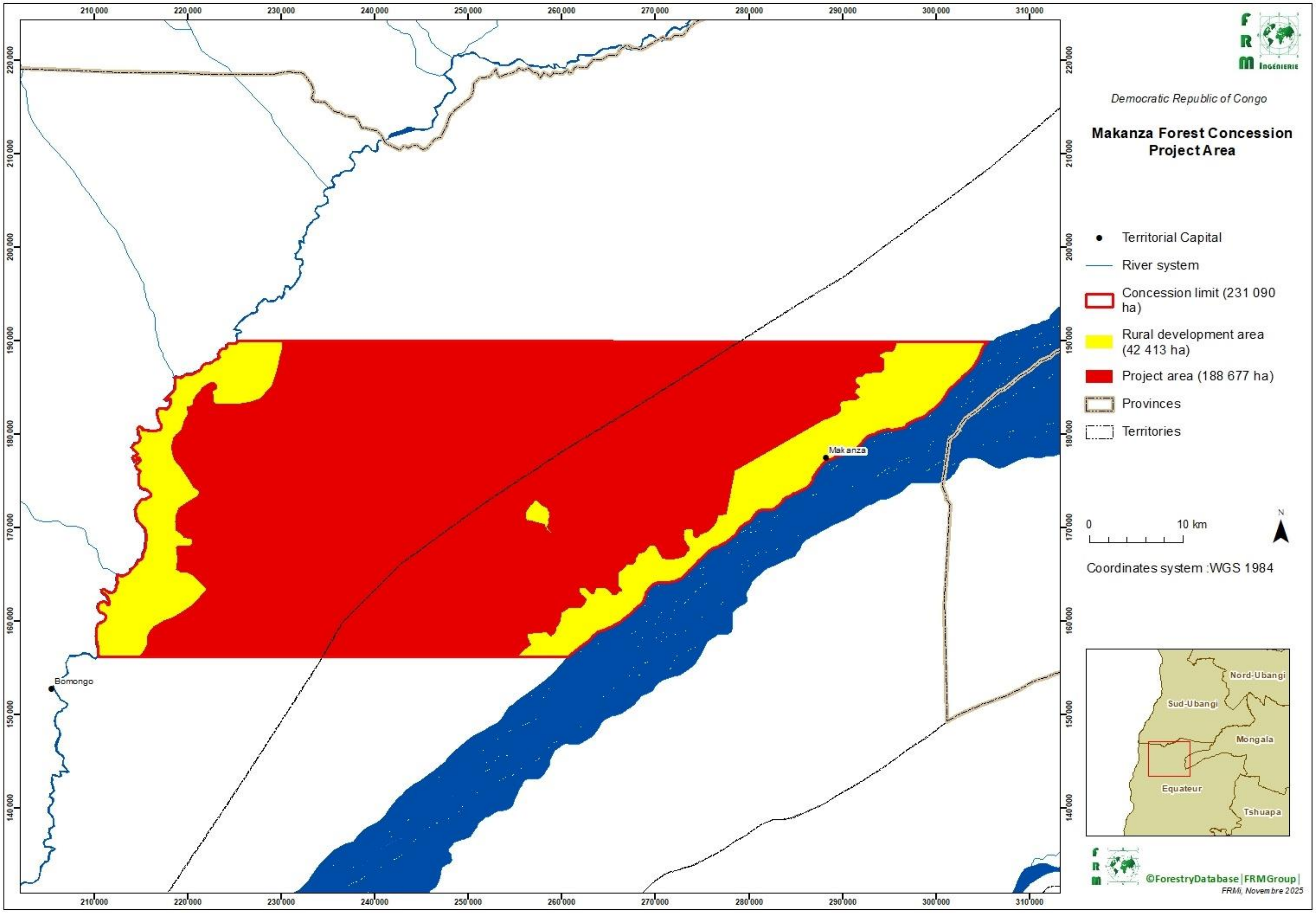


Figure 2: Spatial organization of the Makanza Concession with the project area



1.14 Conditions Prior to Project Initiation

The conditions existing prior to project initiation are the same as the baseline scenario (*i.e.* non assigned peatland forest), please refer to § 3.4.

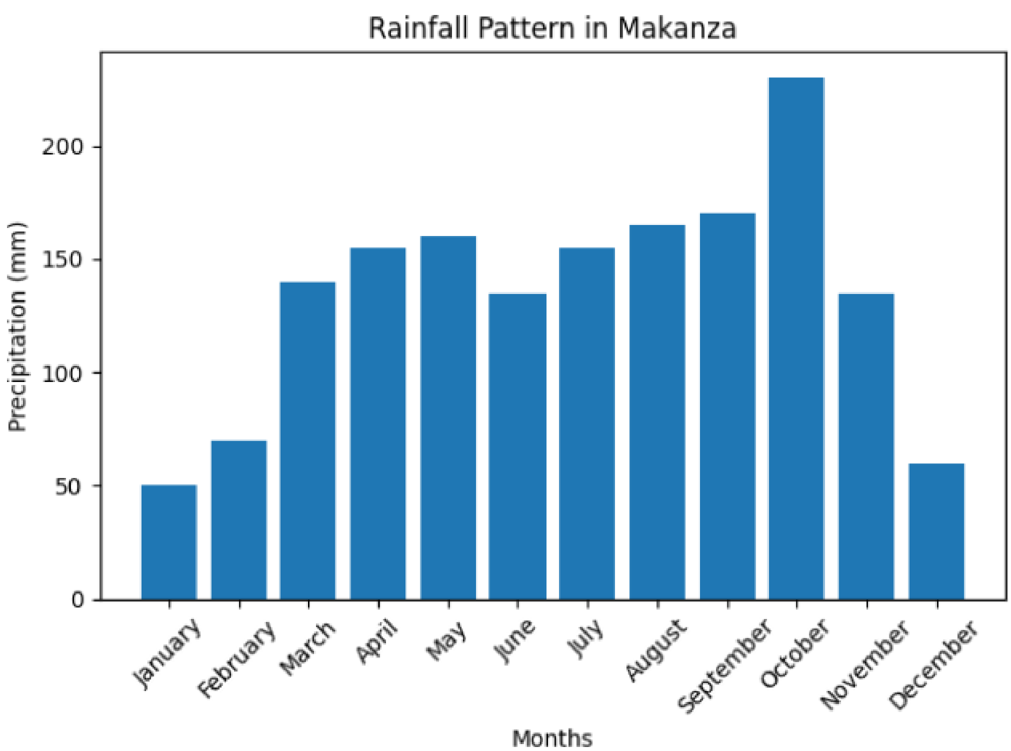
Climate

The Makanza Concession is located in the north-west of the Democratic Republic of Congo, in the "Cuvette centrale", which is one of the wettest areas in the region.

The available rainfall data for the city of Makanza (

Figure 3), in the north-eastern part of the concession indicates an absence of a real dry season, with periods of heavy rainfall ("peaks") being concentrated in April-May and September-October. Total average annual rainfall is high, around 1,650 mm/year (CHIRPS, 2025[10]).

Figure 3: Rainfall curve on Makanza [10]



Own elaboration.

[10] https://www.chc.ucsb.edu/data/chirps, Climate Hazard Center, University of California, Santa Barbara, consulted in December 2025.

Hydrology

The Makanza Concession is bordered by major watercourses, including the Ngiri River (a tributary of the Ubangi River) to the west and the Congo River to the east. The concession is located in the Cuvette Centrale Peatland Complex. These conditions give the area a strongly marshy context (see Figure 4). The concession is characterized by a dense hydrographic network largely composed of channels that, during the rainy season, connect the Ngiri and Congo River[11].

Various waterways on the project area

Topography

The relief is, on the whole, very little marked on the whole of the concession; the variations in altitude are weak and spread out between 290 and 355 m (see Figure 4). The most significant elevation changes are observed in the north-eastern part of the Concession. The slopes are quite low on the concession (rarely exceeding 10%)[12].

Geology and Pedology

The project area is located within the central part of the Congo Basin "Cuvette", where extensive swamp forests and deep peat deposits dominate the landscape[13]. Unlike the *terra firme* forests, the soils within this concession consist almost entirely of hydromorphic and permanently waterlogged substrates. The surface horizon is characterized by peat layers of Holocene to Late Pleistocene origin, formed under persistent anoxic and saturated conditions that limit decomposition and allow the accumulation of

[11] Moukandi N'kaya, G. D., Laraque, A., Paturel, J.-E., Gulemvuga Guzanga, G., Mahé, G., & Tshimanga, R. M. (2022). A New Look at Hydrology in the Congo Basin, Based on the Study of Multi-Decadal Time Series. En R. M. Tshimanga, G. D. Moukandi N'kaya, & D. Alsdorf (Eds.), Congo Basin Hydrology, Climate, and Biogeochemistry: A Foundation for the Future

[12] Georgiou, S., et al. (2023). Mapping Water Levels across a Region of the Cuvette Centrale Peatland Complex. Remote Sensing, 15(12), 3099.

[13] Crezee, B., Dargie, G. C., Ewango, C. E. N., et al. (2022). Mapping peat thickness and carbon stocks of the central Congo Basin using field data. Nature Geoscience, 15, 639–644. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41561-022-00966-7

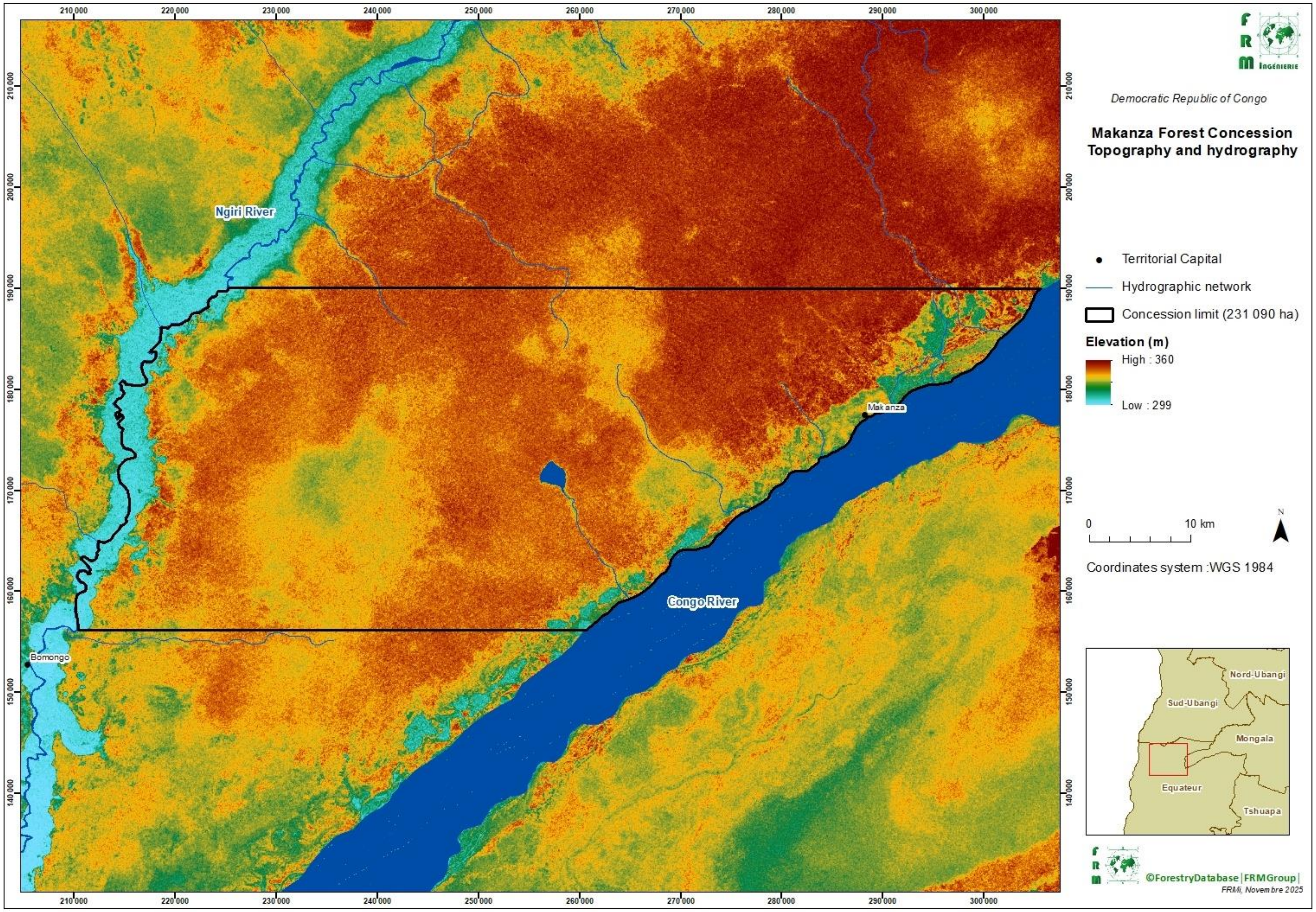
organic matter over millennia. These peat soils typically overlie fine alluvial or lacustrine sediments, reflecting the long-term stability of the inundated environment. The almost continuous waterlogging and the absence of well-drained upland soils define the ecological functioning of the landscape and play a central role in its carbon storage potential [14].

Beneath the peat and Quaternary alluvial sediments, the concession lies within the broader Congo Basin intracratonic depression, which contains a thick sequence of continental and lacustrine deposits of Cenozoic and Mesozoic age. These layers comprise alternating sandstones, siltstones, and clay-rich formations deposited during successive phases of subsidence and sedimentation. At greater depth, this sedimentary package rests on the Precambrian crystalline basement of the Congo Craton. Although concealed today by swamp forests and peatlands, this geological structure influences the region's low-relief topography and the hydrological conditions that favor the long-term development and persistence of peat-forming wetlands[15].

[14] Dargie, G. C., Lewis, S. L., Lawson, I. T., Mitchard, E. T. A., Page, S. E., Bocko, Y. E., & Ifo, S. A. (2017). Age, extent and carbon storage of the central Congo Basin peatland complex. Nature, 542, 86–90. https://doi.org/10.1038/nature21048

[15] Dargie, G. C., Gulliver, P., Lawson, I., Morris, P. J., Crezee, B., et al. (2025). Timing of peat initiation across the central Congo Basin. Environmental Research Letters, 20, 084080. https://doi.org/10.1088/1748-9326/ade905

Figure 4: Topography and hydrography of the Makanza Concession



Ecosystems and vegetation

Flora and land use

The Makanza Concession is characterized by several forest types (see Table 5 and Figure 5), which, in combination with the area's topographic characteristics, form distinct landscapes. The peatland formations show two main types of forest [16]:

- Hardwood-dominated peat swamp forest: This ecosystem type is characterized by the dominance of high-stem, hardwood species such as *Carapa sp, Grossera sp*, *Cleistopholis sp*. and *Uapaca sp*, a relatively high and closed canopy. These forests play a major role in carbon storage and serve as essential habitats for numerous forest species.
- Palm-dominated peat swamp forest: This forest, where the undergrowth tends to be noticeably denser, is dominated by the palm *Raphia laurentii*, which has a low stature (less than 10m), and a non-continuous tree canopy. These areas host specialized fauna and are often located in the basin's wettest or most poorly drained sectors.

These peatland formations are periodically or permanently flooded but do not always lie on peaty soils16.

The forest landscape of the Concession is influenced by various anthropogenic disturbances, including agricultural activities (slash-and-burn agriculture and oil palm plantations)[17] and human infrastructure, which account for 2,4% of the Concession's area[18]. Changes to the forest landscape caused by human activities result in the appearance of degraded forests or savannahs, young forests, forest regrowth, etc. There are also areas of periodically flooded savannah, mainly located along the banks of watercourses.

Table 4, Figure 5 and Figure 6 summarize these different plant formations as well as their areas measured within the limits of the Makanza Concession.

Table 4: Distribution of area by plant formation on the Makanza Concession and project area

Strata		Concession		Project area	
		Surface (ha)	%	Surface (ha)	%
Forest formations on terra	Hardwood-dominated peat swamp forest	195,706	84.7	186,217	99%
	Palm-dominated peat swamp forest	5,855	2.5	2,347	1%
	Terra Firme Dense Evergreen Forest	11,858	5.1	68	0%
	Total forest formations	213,419	92.4	188,677	100%
Non-forest formation	Periodically Flooded Savannah	10,563	4.6	0	0%
	Crop and Housing Complex	5,546	2.4	0	0%
	Open water	1,563	0.7	0	0%
	Non-forest formations	17,671	7.6	0	0%
TOTAL EBUTA CONCESSION		231,090	100%	188,677	100%

[16] Nesha, K., Herold, M., Reiche, J., Masolele, R. N., Hergoualc'h, K., Swails, E., Murdiyarso, D., & Ewango, C. E. N. (2024). An assessment of recent peat forest disturbances and their drivers in the Cuvette Centrale, Africa. Environmental Research Letters, 19(10), 104031. https://doi.org/10.1088/1748-9326/ad6679

[17] Author's own elaboration from field observations

[18] Author's own elaboration based on google earth images

Figure 5: Ecosystems of the Makanza Concession (Outside the Project Area)

Fauna

The Makanza Concession is close (30 km) to the Triangle de la Ngiri Reserve (see Figure 7), and the Ngiri-Tumba - Maï Ndombe cross-border Ramsar Site, the world's largest Ramsar Site.

The Ngiri Triangle Nature Reserve was officially established in March 2011 by a decree of the Ministry of Environment of the Democratic Republic of the Congo. It is managed by the Congolese Institute for Nature Conservation (ICCN), in collaboration with international partners such as WWF. Located at the confluence of the Congo and Ubangi rivers in Equateur province, the reserve covers 1,000 square kilometers. The Ngiri Reserve is mostly covered by swamp forest, seasonally flooded woodlands, and marshy grassland-savanna mosaics. It is an important breeding ground for numerous water birds—such as purple herons, reed cormorants, and African darters—and is home to threatened species including Allen's swamp monkey and the elephant. The reserve was created as part of the transboundary Lake Télé–Lake Tumba Landscape conservation initiative [19].

[19] https://rsis.ramsar.org/ris/1784

Figure 6: Land cover of the Makanza Concession

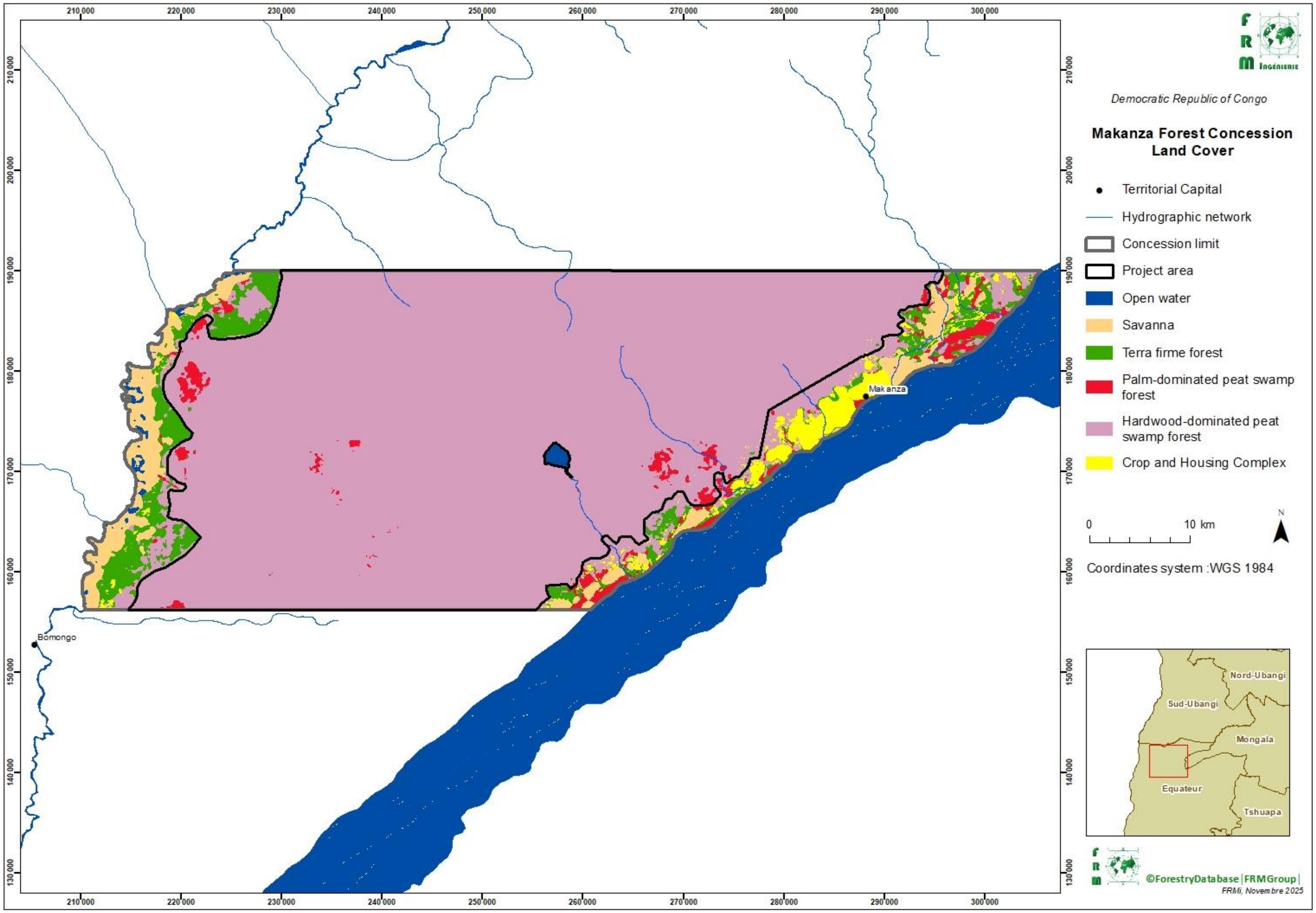
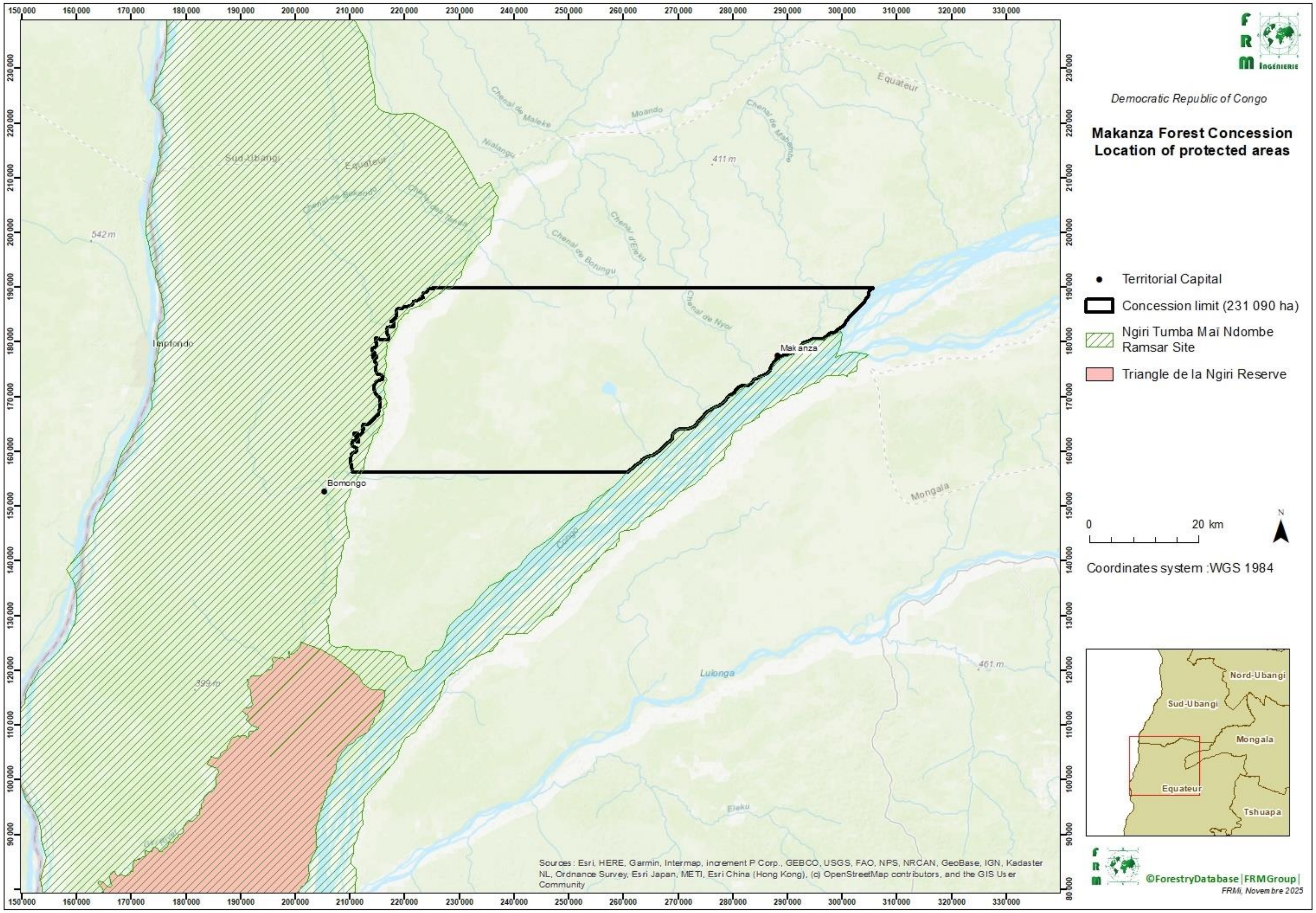


Figure 7: Location of protected areas near the Makanza Concession



Anthropogenic activities and the evolution of forest cover

In the area, two broad population groups can be distinguished:

- Indigenous or historically settled populations, living in officially recognized villages and holding customary land rights.
- Allochthonous populations, who have migrated over the past decade and settled in fishing camps built on stilts along the Congo River. These camps are not recognized as villages, and their occupants do not hold customary rights.

Both groups rely primarily on fishing, supplemented by small-scale subsistence agriculture. However, the forest-use rights differ sharply. Migrant populations residing in fishing camps do not possess customary rights and therefore have very limited access to forest resources. Their use of the forest is generally restricted to collecting dead wood and cultivating small plots near their camps when water levels permit it.

Indigenous populations, by contrast, possess full customary access rights to the forest. They practice small-scale slash-and-burn agriculture, which relies heavily on fire during land preparation. They also use forest resources for pirogue construction, timber extraction (mostly for local use), and fuelwood collection. Some illegal logging also occurs, with timber occasionally transported by raft to Kinshasa.

Most of their use of the forest and peatland areas is related to gathering, particularly the harvesting of non-timber forest products

Economic activities of local communities

The DRC is the second-largest tropical forest country in the world, with 152 million hectares of forest. Nearly 70% of the country's land area is covered by forests, representing 60% of the Congo Basin's forest area. In 2018, the national forest cover was 61.5%, with a deforestation rate of 0.17%[20]. The main drivers of deforestation and forest degradation are slash-and-burn agriculture, logging and charcoal production[21]. This situation is further exacerbated by the combined effects of rapid population growth and deteriorating living conditions. As a result, demand for charcoal, energy wood, and timber, and the area of cultivable land required for traditional agricultural practices (slash-and-burn agriculture), continue to grow in the country, placing forests under extreme pressure and leading to their gradual decline.

Within the Makanza concession, the population's traditional lifestyle, the region's isolation, and the seasonal flooding of forests have relatively preserved forest cover. However, increasing population density, the scarcity of *terra firme* combined with declining fish stocks—due to the growing number of fishermen and the evolution of fishing techniques—is now placing this ecosystem at significant risk.

1.15 Compliance with Laws, Statutes and Other Regulatory Frameworks

According to the "Contrat de Concession Forestière de Conservation n°006/25 du 31 juillet 2025" between the Congolese Government and CNT (available upon request), this area of 231,090 ha, became a conservation forest concession in favor of the CNT company.

The project proponent, CNT, is a private company under Congolese law. The registration documents are available on request. This entity will comply with all applicable local, regional and national laws, regulations and standards. Within the project area, none of the proposed Project Activities violates any laws or regulations. The development of the Project is based on guidelines set out in the country's environmental regulations and laws.

Conservation forest concessions are, as much as timber exploitation concessions, regulated by Law No. 011/2002 of August 29, 2002 on the Forest Code[22] (art. 82 to 95 and art. 119) and its application measures (Decree No. 011/27 of May 20, 2011 setting the specific rules for the allocation of conservation forest concessions[23]). Based on these texts, the regulations in force have clearly provided for specific conditions to be met by any individual or legal entity wishing to enter into a forestry concession contract for timber exploitation or conservation as well as the procedure to be followed by the public administration for this purpose.

Conservation forest concessions in the Democratic Republic of the Congo may be established either by converting former logging concessions or by direct allocation of land that had not previously been brought under concession status. For newly attributed concessions, this process is defined in Decree No. 011/27 of May 20, 2011, which permits any natural or legal person to acquire a conservation concession through

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[20] https://www.un-redd.org/post/la-republique-democratique-du-congo-franchit-une-nouvelle-etape-vers-la-finalisation-de-son#:~:text=En%202018%2C%20le%20couvert%20forestier,production%20de%20charbon%20de%20bois

[21] In the DRC, nearly 95% of the population uses firewood, charcoal or wood waste to prepare meals: Utilisation des makala (du charbon de bois) – Faune et Flore en RDC (wordpress.com)

[22] http://www.droit-afrique.com/upload/doc/rdc/RDC-Code-2002-forestier.pdf

[23] https://faolex.fao.org/docs/pdf/cng111044.pdf

a formal application to the granting authority, without prior logging activity. After thorough examination of the application, the Minister—acting as the granting authority—must transmit the file within eight days of receipt to the central forest administration via the Secretary General, accompanied by the relevant technical and administrative documentation provided by the provincial forest administration, or requested urgently from the provincial governor if missing. The central administration then undertakes all necessary technical and financial reviews. When all requirements have been fulfilled, the Minister notifies the applicant in writing to complete any outstanding obligations, and the concession is awarded through Ministerial Order, followed by the signature of the concession contract within seven days. The awarding order is published in the Official Journal, and copies are distributed to relevant government offices, as stipulated by law. This direct allocation mechanism enables the establishment of new conservation concessions on non-previously allocated territory, supporting the expansion of protected areas and sustainable forest management in the DRC.

In addition, the Democratic Republic of Congo wishes to ensure that the activities implemented within the framework of the REDD+ mechanism develop in coherence with the international agreements and treaties ratified by the State and with the policies and measures in force, in accordance with the decisions of the XVI Conference of the Parties to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change. In this perspective, any project intended to promote its reductions in greenhouse gas emissions linked to REDD+ on the carbon markets or with international institutional buyers, as the Makanza Peatland Project, must be subject to prior approval by the Democratic Republic of Congo[24].

The national approval procedure contributes on the one hand to the concretization of the commitments made by the DRC within the framework of international agreements and conventions and on the other hand to the consistency of REDD+ projects with the existing national framework, in particular the policies and measures, law, eligibility criteria and social and environmental safeguards. The approval of a REDD+ project attests to the legitimacy of the promoter of this REDD+ project with regard to the Congolese State and constitutes a right to promote REDD+ performance on the carbon markets or with any buyer of REDD+ performance from a project located within the borders of the DRC.

Within the framework of the approval, the compliance of the project proponent and the project with a certain number of legal and regulatory requirements are checked, such as for example the regularity of the documents relating to the quality of the project proponent and its partners, the regularity of payment of tax obligations, the land rights of the project promoter in the project area and the means of obtaining these rights, the presence of an environmental certificate issued by the Congolese Environment Agency according to the mechanisms, etc[25].

Before the implementation of project activities, an Environmental and Social Impact Assessment (ESIA) will be conducted so the project can comply with:

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24 https://www.forestcarbonpartnership.org/sites/fcp/files/2015/March/Annexe%20I%20Manuel_Proc%C3%A9dure_Homologation_r%C3%A9vision_version_finale_24f%C3%A9vrier.pdf

25 See the article 10 of the « Arrêté Ministériel n°47/CAB/MIN/EDD/AAN/MML// fixant la procédure d'homologation des investissements REDD+ en République démocratique du Congo (*J.O.RDC., 1er juillet 2018, n°13, col. 58*) : https://faolex.fao.org/docs/pdf/Cng189387.pdf

- The « Loi n°11/009 du 09 juillet 2011 portant principes fondamentaux relatifs à la protection de l'environnement »[26] which in its article 21 "subjects any development, infrastructure or exploitation project of any industrial, commercial, agricultural, forestry, mining, telecommunications or other activity likely to have an impact on the environment to a prior environmental and social impact assessment, together with its management plan, duly approved"

- The « Décret n°13/015 du 29 mai 2013 portant réglementation des installations classées »[27] which in its article 11, paragraph 2, conditions the issue of any license to operate a classified installation on the prior completion of an environmental and social impact study in accordance with article 21 of the « Loi n°11/009 du 09 juillet 2011 portant principes fondamentaux relatifs à la protection de l'environnement ».

- The « Décret n°14/019 du 02 août 2014 fixant les règles de fonctionnement des mécanismes procéduraux de la protection de l'environnement »[28] stipulating in Article 18 that "is obligatorily and previously submitted to an environmental and social impact assessment, together with its management plan, any project for the development, infrastructure or operation of any industrial, commercial, agricultural, forestry, mining, hydrocarbons, cement, telecommunications or other likely to have an impact on the environment".
- The « Loi n°22/030 du 15 juillet 2022 portant protection et promotion des droits des peuples autochtones pygmées »[29] which stipulates in its Article 3 that « The indigenous Pygmy peoples are free and equal in dignity and rights as Congolese citizens. All forms of discrimination against them are prohibited. ».

The ESIA will also establish the list of local, regional and national laws, statutes and regulatory frameworks to which the project complies.

The DRC has signed and ratified or acceded to several international and regional legal instruments aimed at environmental protection and sustainable management of forest and wildlife resources. This signature not only confers benefits, but also obligations and the duty to internalize them. Among these instruments, those applicable to the Makanza Project activities are listed in the Table 5 below.

[26] https://dgrad.gouv.cd/wp-content/uploads/2022/01/Loi-011-009-du-09-juillet-2011_principe-fondamentaux-protection-environnement.pdf

[27] https://www.droitcongolais.info/files/72.05.13-Decret-du-29-mai-2013_Installations-classees.pdf

[28] https://www.leganet.cd/Legislation/Droit%20administratif/Environnement/D.19.019.02.08.214.htm

[29] https://www.leganet.cd/Legislation/Droit%20Public/DH/Loi%2022.030%20du%2015%20juillet%202022.html

Table 5: International and regional conventions ratified by the DRC applicable to the Makanza project activities

Convention	Country/city and date of adoption	Ratification date
Convention concerning the Protection of the World Cultural and Natural Heritage	Paris, France 15 November 1972	23 September 1974[30]
Convention on International Trade of Endangered Species (CITES)	Washington, USA 3 March 1973	18 October 1976[31]
African Convention on the Conservation of Nature and Natural Resources	Algiers, Algeria 15 September 1968	29 May 1976[32]
Convention on the Conservation of Migratory Species Wildlife (Bonn Convention)	Bonn, Germany 23 June 1979	1st September 1990[33]
Vienna Convention on the Protection of the Ozone Layer	Vienna, Austria 22 March 1985	30 November 1994[30]
Convention on Biological Diversity	Rio de Janeiro, Brazil 5 June 1992	3 December 1994[30]
United Nations Convention on Climate Change	New-York, USA 9 May 1992	9 January 1995[30]
Convention on Wetlands of International Importance especially as Waterfowl Habitat (Ramsar)	Ramsar, Iran 2 February 1971	18 January 1996[34]
United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification in Those Countries Experiencing Serious Drought and/or Desertification, particularly in Africa	Paris, France 16 June 1994	12 September 1997[30]
Kyoto Protocol to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change	Kyoto, Japan 10 December 1997	23 March 2005[30]

30 https://www.wipo.int/wipolex/fr/treaties/members/profile/CD

31 https://www.leganet.cd/Legislation/Droit%20administratif/Environnement/A.056.28.03.2000.htm

32 https://au.int/en/treaties/african-convention-conservation-nature-and-natural-resources

33 https://www.cms.int/sites/default/files/document/Inf_12_17_NationalReport_DRO_Congo_F_0.pdf

34 https://www.unesco.org/fr/countries/cd/conventions

Rotterdam Convention on the Prior Informed Consent Procedure for Certain Hazardous Chemicals and Pesticides in International Trade	Rotterdam, Netherlands 10 September 1998	23 March 2005[35]
Stockholm Convention on Persistent Organic Pollutants (POPs)	Stockholm, Sweden 22 May 2001	23 March 2005[36]
Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples	New York, USA 13 September 2007	13 September 2007[37]
Nagoya Protocol on Access to Genetic Resources and the Fair and Equitable Sharing of Benefits Arising from their Utilization to the Convention on Biological Diversity	Nagoya, Japan 28 October 2010	4 February 2015[30]
International Plant Protection Convention	Rome, Italy 5 December 1951	4 May 2015[30]
Paris Agreement	Paris, France 11 December 2015	13 December 2017[30]

The DRC has not ratified the ILO Convention C169 on Indigenous and Tribal Peoples[38].

Since 2011, the DRC has had an improved legal and regulatory arsenal for the environment and the sustainable management of forest and wildlife resources. An evolution of the legislative and regulatory framework for environmental management and nature conservation has marked the last decade (2010-2020). These legal documents, which constitute the legal basis for sustainable environmental management, include:

- Legal texts:
  - « Loi n°11/022 du 24 décembre 2011 portant principes fondamentaux relatifs à l'agriculture » ;
  - « Loi n°011/2002 du 29 août 2002 portant Code forestier » ;
  - « Loi n°82/002 du 28 mai 1982 portant réglementation de la chasse » ;
  - « Loi n°11/009 du 09 juillet 2011 portant principes fondamentaux relatifs à la protection de l'environnement telle que modifiée et complétée ce jour par l'Ordonnance-Loi n°23/007 du 03 mars 2023 » ;
  - « Loi n°14/003 du 11 février 2014 relative à la Conservation de la Nature » ;
  - « Loi n°15/026 du 31 décembre 2015 relative à l'eau » ;

35 https://treaties.un.org/pages/ViewDetails.aspx?src=TREATY&mtdsg_no=XXVII-14&chapter=27&clang=_fr

36 https://treaties.un.org/pages/ViewDetails.aspx?src=TREATY&mtdsg_no=XXVII-15&chapter=27&clang=_fr

37 https://digitallibrary.un.org/record/609197?ln=en

38 https://normlex.ilo.org/dyn/nrmlx_en/f?p=NORMLEXPUB:11300:0::NO::P11300_INSTRUMENT_ID:312314

- Regulatory texts:
  - « Décret n° 14/030 du 18 novembre 2014 fixant les règles de fonctionnement des mécanismes procéduraux de la protection de l'environnement ».

Finally, the Project is also required to comply with the following legal/regulatory texts:

- « Loi n° 16/010 du 15 juillet 2016 modifiant et complétant la Loi n° 015-2002 portant Code du travail » ;
- « Loi n° 14/011 du 17 juin 2014 qui régit le secteur de l'électricité en RDC » ;
- « Décret-loi 081 du 02 juillet 1998 portant organisation territoriale et administrative de la République Démocratique du Congo » ;
- « Décret n° 13/015 du 29 mai 2013 portant réglementation des installations classées ».

1.16 Double Counting and Participation under Other GHG Programs

1.16.1 No Double Issuance

Is the project receiving or seeking credit for reductions and removals from a project activity under another GHG program?

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.16.2 Registration in Other GHG Programs

Has the project registered under any other GHG programs?

☐ Yes ☒ No

Is the project active under the other program?

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.16.3 Projects Rejected by Other GHG Programs

Has the project been rejected by any other GHG programs?

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.17 Double Claiming, Other Forms of Credit, and Scope 3 Emissions

1.17.1 No Double Claiming with Emissions Trading Programs or Binding Emission Limits

Are project reductions and removals or project activities also included in an emissions trading program or binding emission limit? See the *VCS Program Definitions* for definitions of emissions trading program and binding emission limit.

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.17.2 No Double Claiming with Other Forms of Environmental Credit

Has the project activity sought, received, or is planning to receive credit from another GHG-related environmental credit system? See the *VCS Program Definitions* for definition of GHG-related environmental credit system.

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.17.3 Supply Chain (Scope 3) Emissions

Do the project activities specified in Section 0 affect the emissions footprint of any product(s) (goods or services) that are part of a supply chain?

☐ Yes ☒ No

Is the project proponent(s) or authorized representative a buyer or seller of the product(s) (goods or services) that are part of a supply chain?

☐ Yes ☒ No

Has the project proponent(s) or authorized representative posted a public statement on their website saying, "Carbon credits may be issued through Verified Carbon Standard project [project ID] for the greenhouse gas emission reductions or removals associated with [project proponent or authorized representative organization name(s)] [name of product(s) whose emissions footprint is changed by the project activities]."

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.18 Sustainable Development Contributions

Since the adoption of the 2030 Agenda, several stakeholders in the DRC have mobilized around this ambitious program and its 17 SDGs (see Figure 8).

On the social front, reforms have expanded social protection coverage, increased budgetary resources for the health sector, and initiated steps toward universal health care. The Government has also taken a strategic direction to combat hunger and malnutrition. Access to water and electricity, however, remains a major challenge, and the energy supply is still insufficient despite considerable national potential. Additional efforts aim to reduce extreme poverty and inequality. To promote access to education for all, the Government has made basic education free of charge, set up a quality assurance scheme, and reformed the teacher recruitment system. Gender equality is one of the DRC's priorities, and reforms to the legal framework on women's rights have led to the revision of the Family Code.

On the environmental front, several climate change mitigation and adaptation projects have been initiated, although greater sectoral synergies remain necessary. Conservation and biodiversity protection efforts, including the management of parks and nature reserves, are regularly undertaken.

The project contributes to national sustainable development priorities in various ways:

- SDG 13 & 15: The project directly supports climate change mitigation by conserving a large forest and soil carbon stock that was previously unallocated and therefore exposed to degradation or destruction;
- SDG 1, 2, 5, 8, 9, 10 & 12: by creating jobs (supervisory staff, awareness-raising agents) and establishing sustainable agricultural or economic activities, the project helps combat rural exodus and brings significant, lasting improvements to local communities. These jobs and activities will be accessible to all without gender inequality or discrimination. Salaries and income from agricultural production will be an effective tool for poverty reduction and a driver of local development
- SDG 3,4 & 6 with the construction or renovations of infrastructures;
- SDG 14 & 15: the project conserves and enhances biodiversity by:
    - Protecting the Concession from destructive and illegal anthropogenic activities such as recurrent and uncontrolled burning (for slash-and-burn agriculture) or the anarchic collection of wood (energy or timber);
    - the drainage of wetlands and the preservation of aquatic species
    - The introduction of awareness-raising and training programs for sustainable and environmentally friendly activities in order to change the habits (often harmful to forests and biodiversity) of local communities.

The climate, environmental and community benefits provided by the project all contribute to the achievement of global and national sustainable development goals. These contributory services will be monitored as part of the approval procedure for REDD+ investments in the DRC. During the implementation of a REDD+ investment, the proponent is required to send a report every 12 months to the regulator (*i.e.* the CN-REDD[39]) to report on the progress of the implementation of its REDD+ investment. The CN-REDD will also be responsible for carrying out control audits in the field[40].

[39] https://medd.gouv.cd/coordination-nationale-redd-cn-redd/

[40] See the articles 23 and 27 of the « Arrêté Ministériel n°47/CAB/MIN/EDD/AAN/MML// fixant la procédure d'homologation des investissements REDD+ en République démocratique du Congo (J.O.RDC., 1er juillet 2018, n°13, col. 58) » https://faolex.fao.org/docs/pdf/Cng189387.pdf

Figure 8: SDGs in Democratic Republic of Congo[41]

1.19 Additional Information Relevant to the Project

1.19.1 Leakage Management

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, December 2025).

1.19.2 Commercially Sensitive Information

No commercially sensitive information has been excluded from the public version of the project description.

1.19.3 Further Information

The Makanza Project is part of an integrated development strategy and aims to promote social and environmental practices.

[41] https://drcongo.un.org/fr/sdgs

2 SAFEGUARDS AND STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT

2.1 Stakeholder Engagement and Consultation

2.1.1 Stakeholder Identification

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.1.2 Stakeholder Consultation and Ongoing Communication

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.1.3 Free Prior and Informed Consent

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.1.4 Grievance Redress Procedure

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.1.5 Public Comments

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.2 Risks to Stakeholders and the Environment

2.2.1 Management Experience

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.2.2 Risk Assessment

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.3 Respect for Human Rights and Equity

2.3.1 Labor and Work

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.3.2 Human Rights

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.3.3 Indigenous Peoples and Cultural Heritage

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.3.4 Property Rights

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.3.5 Benefit Sharing

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.4 Ecosystem Health

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.4.1 Rare, Threatened, and Endangered Species

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.4.2 Introduction of Species

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

2.4.3 Ecosystem Conversion

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

3 APPLICATION OF METHODOLOGY

3.1 Title and Reference of Methodology

The Makanza project applies the latest version of VCS Methodology VM0007 (version 1.8). Applicable modules are listed in Table 6.

Table 6: The title, reference and version number for the methodology, tools and modules applied to the project

Type (methodology, tool or module).	Reference ID, if applicable	Title	Version
Methodology	VM0007	Methodology for Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation	1.8[42]
Tool	VT0001	Tool for the Demonstration and Assessment of Additionality in VCS Agriculture, Forestry and Other Land Use (AFOLU) Project Activities	3.0[43]
Methodology	-	VCS Program Guide	5[44]
Methodology	-	VCS Standard	5[45]
Methodology	-	VCS Methodology Requirements	5[46]
Methodology	-	Registration and Issuance Process guidance	5[47]

[42] https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/11/VM0048-Reducing-Emissions-from-Deforestation-and-Forest-Degradation-v1.0-1-1.pdf

[43] https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/imported/methodologies/VT0001v3.0.pdf

[44] https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/12/VCS-Program-Guide-v5.0.pdf

[45] https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/12/VCS-Standard-v5.0.pdf

[46] https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/12/VCS-Methodology-Requirements-v5.0.pdf

[47] https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/12/Registration-and-Issuance-Process-v5.0.pdf

Tool	-	AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool	4.2[48]
Module	VMD0001	Estimation of carbon stocks in the above- and below-ground biomass in live tree and non-tree pools (CP-AB)	1.1[49]
Module	VMD0042	Estimation of baseline soil carbon stock changes and greenhouse gas emissions in peatland rewetting and conservation project activities (BL-PEAT)	2.2[50]
Module	VMD0007	Estimation of baseline carbon stock changes and greenhouse gas emissions from unplanned deforestation and unplanned wetland degradation (BL-UP)	3.3[51]
Module	VMD010	Estimation of emissions from activity shifting for avoided unplanned deforestation and avoiding unplanned deforestation and avoiding planned wetland degradation (LK-ASU)	1.2[52]
Module	VMD016	Methods for stratification of the project area (X-STR)	1.2[53]
Module	VMD017	Estimation of uncertainty for REDD project activities (X-UNC)	2.2[54]

[48] https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/10/AFOLU-Non-Permanence-Risk-Tool-v4.2-FINAL.pdf

[49] https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/11/VMD0001-Estimation-of-Carbon-Stocks-in-Above-and-Belowground-Biomass-in-Live-Tree-and-Non-tree-Pools-CP-AB-v1.2.pdf

[50] https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/imported/methodologies/VMD0042-BL-PEAT-v1.1.pdf

[51] https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/imported/methodologies/VMD0007-BL-UP_v3.3.pdf

[52] https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/imported/methodologies/VMD0010-LK-ASU-v1.2.pdf

[53] https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/11/VMD0016-Methods-for-Stratification-of-the-Project-Area-X-STR-v1.3.pdf

[54] https://verra.org/wp-content/uploads/imported/methodologies/VMD0017-X-UNC_v2.2.pdf

3.2 Applicability of Methodology

Applicability Conditions of VM0007 – REDD+

The VCS VM0007 methodology "Methodology for Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation" (Version 1.8) is applicable under the following conditions:

1. Land in the project area has qualified as forest for at least 10 years before the project start date.
2. Where land within the project area is peatland or tidal wetlands and emissions from the SOC pool are deemed significant, the relevant WRC modules are applied alongside other relevant modules
3. Baseline deforestation in the project area falls within either of the following categories:
   - Unplanned deforestation (VCS category AUDef)
   - Planned deforestation (VCS category APDef)

REDD activity types are not applicable under the following conditions:

4. Leakage prevention activity conditions include:
   - Flooding agricultural lands to increase production (e.g., rice paddies); and/or
   - Intensifying livestock production through the use of feedlots and/or manure lagoons

Avoiding unplanned deforestation activities are applicable under the following conditions:

5. Baseline agents of deforestation meet all of the following criteria:
   - Clear the land for tree harvesting, settlements, crop production (agriculturalist), ranching or aquaculture, where such clearing for crop production, ranching or aquaculture does not amount to large-scale industrial agriculture or aquaculture activities
   - Have no documented and uncontested legal right to deforest the land for these purposes; and
   - Are either residents in the reference region for deforestation or immigrants.

Avoiding unplanned deforestation activities are not applicable under the following conditions.

6. Post-deforestation land use in the baseline scenario constitutes reforestation.

The Makanza project meets these conditions as:

1. The project area has been forested for at least 10 years prior to the project start date.
2. The project area is a forest located on an undrained peatland; therefore, it has been considered as CIW + REDD.
3. The baseline deforestation in the project is classified as unplanned deforestation per the selected baseline scenario.
4. The Project does not plan to either flood agricultural lands to increase production or intensify livestock production through the use of feedlots and/or manure lagoons.
5. The baseline agents of deforestation clear the land for tree harvesting or crop production and have no documented or uncontested legal right to deforest the land for these purposes.
6. The post-deforestation land use in the baseline scenario does not constitute reforestation.

Methodology ID	Applicability condition	Justification of compliance
VM0007	See Section 3.2.1	Condition met. *See Section 3.2*
VT0001	AFOLU activities the same or similar to the proposed project activity on the land within the proposed project boundary performed with or without being registered as the VCS AFOLU project shall not lead to violation of any applicable law even if the law is not enforced	The Makanza Project does not violate any laws as demonstrated in section 1.15
VMD0007	Applicable for estimating baseline emissions from unplanned deforestation (conversion of forest land to non-forest land) where the forest landscape configuration is mosaic, transition or frontier, and where baseline agents of deforestation: (i) clear land for settlements, crop production, ranching or aquaculture (non-industrial scale); (ii) have no documented and uncontested legal right to deforest for these purposes; and (iii) are resident in the reference region or immigrants. Where pre-project unsustainable fuelwood collection occurs within project boundaries, Modules BL-DFW and LK-DFW must be applied to assess potential leakage.	Condition met. Baseline deforestation is classified as unplanned deforestation (AUDef) and is driven by non-industrial agents clearing land mainly for smallholder crop production/settlements (and associated activities). Based on the legal and contextual assessment, these agents do not hold a documented and uncontested legal right to deforest for these purposes. Baseline agents are residents of the reference region and/or immigrants. Pre-project unsustainable fuelwood collection is not identified as occurring within the project boundary; therefore BL-DFW and LK-DFW are not applicable
VMD0042 BL-PEAT	This module is applicable to RDP and CUPP activities on project areas that meet the VCS definition for peatland. The scope of this module is limited to domed peatlands in the tropical climate zone.	Condition met. The project area comprises undrained peatland within the Cuvette Centrale Peatland Complex, with hydromorphic and permanently waterlogged substrates and peat layers/deep peat deposits, consistent with the VCS definition of peatland. The concession lies in the tropical climate zone (high annual rainfall and no marked dry season). The project area is located between the Ngiri River and the Congo River and exhibits very low-relief topography (approx. 290–355 m), with an interfluvial, gently elevated interior relative to the river margins, consistent with domed

		peatland morphology (Figure 4). (See Sections 1.14: Climate/Hydrology/Topography/Geology & Pedology; Figure 4).
VMD010	This module is applicable for estimating carbon stock changes and greenhouse gas emissions related to the displacement of activities that cause deforestation of lands or wetland degradation outside the project area due to avoiding unplanned deforestation or avoiding unplanned wetland degradation in the project area. Activities subject to potential displacement are conversion of forest land to grazing lands, croplands, and other land uses, or conversion of intact or partially degraded wetlands to drained or degraded wetlands. The module is mandatory if module BL-UP has been used to define the baseline and the applicability conditions in module BL-UP must be complied with in full.	Condition met. VMD010 is applicable and mandatory (baseline defined with BL-UP). Leakage assessment/quantification TBD in Section 4.3 (Leakage Emissions).
VMD016	For peatland rewetting and conservation project activities this module must be used to delineate non-peat versus peat and to stratify the peat according to peat depth and soil emission characteristics, unless it can be demonstrated that the expected emissions from the soil organic carbon pool or change in the soil organic carbon pool in the project scenario is de minimis. In the case of WRC project activities, the project boundary must be designed such that the negative effect of drainage activities that occur outside the project area on the project GHG benefits are minimized.	Condition met. The project area comprises forest on undrained peatland within the Cuvette Centrale Peatland Complex, characterized by hydromorphic and permanently waterlogged substrates and deep peat deposits; therefore, expected emissions from the SOC pool are not de minimis and SOC is included as a major carbon pool. Accordingly, VMD016 (X-STR) is applied to delineate peat vs. non-peat areas and stratify peat by peat depth and soil emission characteristics. The project boundary follows the Makanza conservation concession and excludes the rural development area; given the strongly marshy hydrological context, the boundary design aims to minimize potential negative effects of

		any drainage activities occurring outside the project area.
VMD017	This module is mandatory when using the methodology REDD+ MF. It is applicable for estimating the uncertainty of estimates of emissions and removals of CO2-e generated from REDD and WRC project activities. Where an uncertainty value is not known or cannot be simply calculated, a project must justify that it is using an indisputably conservative number and an uncertainty of 0% may be used for this component. Guidance on uncertainty – a precision target of a 95% confidence interval half-width equal to or less than 15% of the recorded value must be targeted. This is especially important in terms of project planning for the measurement of carbon stocks; sufficient measurement plots should be included to achieve this precision level across the measured stocks.	Condition met. VMD017 is mandatory under REDD+-MF and will be applied to quantify and report uncertainty of project emissions/removals (REDD & CIW). Results TBD in the final PD once carbon stock/activity data are finalized.

3.3 Project Boundary

Geographical boundaries

Figure 1 in §1.13 shows the location of concession Makanza, the concession in which the project area is located. The Makanza Concession is located in the Democratic Republic of Congo, in the Equateur Province and has a total area of 231,090 ha.

Figure 2, also in §1.13, shows the different areas of the Makanza Concession. The project area is 188,677 ha.

The geographical boundaries may evolve before the launching of the project and the commencement of activities but then will not change over the project lifetime.

Temporal boundaries

The temporal boundaries are defined by the project start date and length of the project crediting period. The project activity directly leading to the sequestration of CO_2 will start on January 01, 2027 with the launching of the project (see §1.8 for more details). The length of the project crediting period is 40 years.

Carbon pools

The carbon pools included or excluded from the project boundary are shown in the table below.

Carbon pools	Included?	Justification/Explanation of choice
Aboveground tree biomass	Included	Major pool; expected to decrease in baseline due to deforestation/degradation; included to avoid underestimation.
Belowground tree biomass	Included	Major carbon pool that will significantly decrease in the baseline scenario in the case of deforestation or forest degradation
Aboveground non-tree biomass	Excluded	Insignificant and exclusion is conservative.
Belowground non-tree biomass	Excluded	Potential emissions are negligible.
Dead wood	Excluded	Exclusion is conservative.
Litter	Excluded	Insignificant and exclusion is conservative.
Peat soil carbon pool	Included	Soil organic carbon (including peat) is a major pool in forested peatlands and may decrease substantially under drainage/fire associated with baseline land-use change
Harvested wood products	Excluded	No long-lived harvested wood products are expected. Any wood extraction is for short-lived energy uses (fuelwood/charcoal) and is treated as oxidized in the biomass loss accounting (therefore HWP pool not applicable)

Greenhouse Gases

The emission sources included in or excluded from the project boundary are shown in the table below.

Source		Gas	Included?	Justification/Explanation
Baseline	Combustion of fossil fuels	CO_2	No	Only included if tested as significant. Otherwise excluded, which is deemed conservative, as emissions will be greater in the baseline scenario than in the project scenario. The project proponent has chosen to exclude to account for GHG emissions related to the combustion of fossil fuels, which is conservative.
		CH_4	No	
		N_2O	No	

Source		Gas	Included?	Justification/Explanation
	Burning of woody biomass	CO_2	Yes	CH_4 emissions included as CO_2 equivalent emissions N_2O potential emissions are negligible
		CH_4	Yes	
		N_2O	No	
	Use of fertilizers	CO_2	No	Potential emissions are negligible. Following the VCS update to the Tool for AFOLU Methodological Issues and Guidance for AFOLU Projects, emissions through the use of fertilizer are considered insignificant and are not considered here.
		CH_4	No	
		N_2O	No	
Project	Combustion of fossil fuels	CO_2	No	Only included if tested as significant. Otherwise excluded, which is deemed conservative, as emissions will be greater in the baseline scenario than in the project scenario. Not applicable in the project scenario.
		CH_4	No	
		N_2O	No	
	Burning of woody biomass	CO_2	Yes	Major emission sources
		CH_4	Yes	
		N_2O	Yes	
	Use of fertilizers	CO_2	No	Potential emissions are negligible. Following the VCS update to the Tool for AFOLU Methodological Issues and Guidance for AFOLU Projects, emissions through the use of fertilizer are considered insignificant and are not considered here.
		CH_4	No	
		N_2O	No	

3.4 Baseline Scenario

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

3.5 Additionality

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

3.5.1 Regulatory Surplus

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

3.5.2 Additionality Methods

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

3.6 Methodology Deviations

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

4 QUANTIFICATION OF ESTIMATED GHG EMISSION REDUCTIONS AND REMOVALS

4.1 Baseline Emissions

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

4.2 Project Emissions

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

4.3 Leakage Emissions

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

4.4 Estimated GHG Emission Reductions and Carbon Dioxide Removals

In the following table, we present the initial ex ante estimates of the VCUs that could be generated by the concession's REDD+ project. These figures will be refined and adjusted in the final version of the PDD.

Vintage period	Estimated baseline emissions (tCO2e)	Estimated project emissions (tCO2e)	Estimated leakage emissions (tCO2e)	Estimated reduction VCUs (tCO2e)	Estimated removal VCUs (tCO2e)	Estimated total VCUs (tCO2e)
1 January 2027 to 31 December 2027	332,596	66,519	53,215	212,862	-	212,862
1 January 2028 to 31 December 2028	354,664	71,058	56,721	226,885	-	226,885
1 January 2029 to 31 December 2029	376,681	75,596	60,217	240,868	-	240,868
1 January 2030 to 31 December 2030	398,645	80,130	63,703	254,811	-	254,811
1 January 2031 to 31 December 2031	420,557	84,663	67,179	268,715	-	268,715
1 January 2032 to 31 December 2032	442,418	89,194	70,645	282,579	-	282,579
1 January 2030 to 33 December 2033	464,227	93,722	74,101	296,403	-	296,403
1 January 2034 to 31 December 2034	485,984	98,249	77,547	310,188	-	310,188
1 January 2035 to 31 December 2035	507,690	102,773	80,984	323,934	-	323,934
1 January 2036 to 31 December 2036	529,345	107,295	84,410	337,640	-	337,640
1 January 2037 to 31 December 2037	550,949	111,815	87,827	351,308	-	351,308
1 January 2038 to 31 December 2038	572,502	116,333	91,234	364,936	-	364,936
1 January 2039 to 31 December 2039	594,004	120,848	94,631	378,525	-	378,525
1 January 2040 to 31 December 2040	615,456	125,362	98,019	392,075	-	392,075
1 January 2041 to 31 December 2041	636,857	129,873	101,397	405,586	-	405,586
1 January 2042 to 31 December 2042	658,207	134,383	104,765	419,059	-	419,059
1 January 2043 to 31 December 2043	679,507	138,890	108,123	432,493	-	432,493
1 January 2044 to 31 December 2044	700,756	143,395	111,472	445,889	-	445,889
1 January 2045 to 31 December 2045	721,956	147,898	114,812	459,246	-	459,246
1 January 2046 to 31 December 2046	743,105	152,399	118,141	472,565	-	472,565
1 January 2047 to 31 December 2047	764,205	156,897	121,461	485,846	-	485,846

Vintage period	Estimated baseline emissions (tCO2e)	Estimated project emissions (tCO2e)	Estimated leakage emissions (tCO2e)	Estimated reduction VCUs (tCO2e)	Estimated removal VCUs (tCO2e)	Estimated total VCUs (tCO2e)
1 January 2048 to 31 December 2048	785,255	161,394	124,772	499,089	-	499,089
1 January 2049 to 31 December 2049	806,255	165,888	128,073	512,293	-	512,293
1 January 2050 to 31 December 2050	827,205	170,381	131,365	525,460	-	525,460
1 January 2051 to 31 December 2051	848,106	174,871	134,647	538,588	-	538,588
1 January 2052 to 31 December 2052	868,958	179,359	137,920	551,679	-	551,679
1 January 2053 to 31 December 2053	889,761	183,845	141,183	564,733	-	564,733
1 January 2054 to 31 December 2054	910,514	188,329	144,437	577,749	-	577,749
1 January 2055 to 31 December 2055	931,219	192,810	147,682	590,727	-	590,727
1 January 2056 to 31 December 2056	951,874	197,290	150,917	603,668	-	603,668
1 January 2057 to 31 December 2057	972,481	201,767	154,143	616,571	-	616,571
1 January 2058 to 31 December 2058	993,040	206,243	157,359	629,438	-	629,438
1 January 2059 to 31 December 2059	1,013,550	210,716	160,567	642,267	-	642,267
1 January 2060 to 31 December 2060	1,034,011	215,187	163,765	655,059	-	655,059
1 January 2061 to 31 December 2061	1,054,424	219,656	166,954	667,814	-	667,814
1 January 2062 to 31 December 2062	1,074,789	224,123	170,133	680,533	-	680,533
1 January 2063 to 31 December 2063	1,095,106	228,588	173,304	693,215	-	693,215
1 January 2064 to 31 December 2064	1,115,375	233,051	176,465	705,860	-	705,860
1 January 2065 to 31 December 2065	1,127,524	235,897	178,325	713,302	-	713,302
1 January 2066 to 31 December 2066	1,139,644	238,742	180,181	720,722	-	720,722
Total estimated ERRs during the first or fixed crediting period	29,989,403	6,175,428	4,762,795	19,051,180		19,051,180
Total number of years	40	-	-			-
Average annual ERRs	749,735.07	154,385.69	119,069.88	476,279.50	-	476,279.50

5 MONITORING

5.1 Data and Parameters Available at Validation

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

5.2 Data and Parameters Monitored

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).

5.3 Monitoring Plan

This section has been omitted in accordance with the Pipeline Listing Process defined in section 3.1.3 of VERRA's Registration and Issuance Process guidance (v5, 16 December 2025).